

Structural Framing

Brian Skupien, a structural engineer with the consulting firm raSmith, credits Project Lead the Way with impacting his career choice. He recalls, “One of the projects in PLTW Principles of Engineering I remember is a research assignment where we had to pick a field of engineering, find a university that offers that degree, and figure out what classes we had to take. We also had to interview someone in the field. I picked civil engineering, and that is the field I went into.”

As a structural engineer, Brian designs cold-formed metal wall studs, a lightweight, cost-effective building material for low-rise and mid-rise building projects. The wall studs Brian designs are used in hospitals, distilleries, apartment buildings, hotels, and shopping malls. While each project comes with its own set of challenges and design requirements, Brian loves how working on projects all across the United States lets him learn from other engineers and trade workers to improve his craft. If Brian is stuck on part of a structural design, he knows that chances are, a coworker has seen something similar to his framing problem.

As a volunteer with Engineers Without Borders, Brian shared his expertise with students from Marquette University. He guided students through the structural design of a small school for a growing community in Guatemala. To answer their questions, he relied on communication skills honed through daily communication with clients. As Brian states, “No matter what job you are in, you will always be part of a team, and communicating and working with them will be necessary.”

Building a Career



Brian Skupien
Structural Engineer
raSmith

“Follow your passions. If you find out you aren’t interested in what you are studying in college, there is no shame in switching.”

